Disaster Risk, Nursing Preparedness, and Continuity

NURSING · nursing-foundations · BoardPrep lesson v2

Official examination scope

The PRC nursing references define examination scope, not a clinical or operational protocol. This lesson uses the WHO Health EDRM framework for general, all-hazards preparedness and risk reasoning. Philippine disaster governance, incident command, triage, evacuation, referral, and facility continuity procedures must be verified locally. This lesson does not assign authority or treatment actions.

Learning objectives

- Distinguish prevention/preparedness/readiness from response and recovery as connected parts of
- health emergency risk management.
- Explain why risk planning includes communities, health-system functions, multiple sectors, and
- people who may face disproportionate harm.
- Apply a bounded nursing role in preparedness by identifying information, coordination,
- communication, and continuity needs without inventing local command rules.

1. Treat disaster nursing as risk management across phases

Health emergency and disaster risk management is broader than responding after an event starts. WHO frames it across prevention, preparedness and readiness, response, and recovery, using an all-hazards approach and whole-health-system participation. Nursing reasoning therefore asks what could harm health, which groups and services are exposed, what capacity is available, and what needs preparation before, during, and after an event. For example, a forecast storm may threaten access to chronic-care services before anyone is injured; mapping affected groups, service dependencies, and communication gaps is already health-risk work. Distinguish a hazard from an observed clinical problem and do not treat a general framework as a local triage algorithm. The exact response authority, incident structure, and facility duties must come from current Philippine and local plans.

Sources for this section

Section reference: Health Emergency and Disaster Risk Management Framework — World Health Organization — https://www.who.int/publications/i/item/health-emergency-and-disaster-risk-management-framework

2. Plan with communities and protect continuity

WHO’s framework emphasizes that no single agency manages health emergency risk alone: whole-health-system and multisector coordination matter, and communities should participate in planning. It also notes that emergencies can disproportionately affect people with disabilities, older adults, children, migrants, displaced people, and those with chronic disease. A nurse contributing to preparedness can help identify communication, access, referral, staffing, information, and continuity needs with the affected people and authorized partners. In a flood-prone area, the team might verify which accessible contact route and current local contingency plan apply to people relying on regular care; a nurse does not independently promise transport, medication supply, or a clinical intervention. Protect privacy when using lists and follow the designated information-sharing rules. This is a planning principle, not a substitute for Philippine disaster plans or facility command procedures.

Sources for this section

Section reference: Health Emergency and Disaster Risk Management Framework — World Health Organization — https://www.who.int/publications/i/item/health-emergency-and-disaster-risk-management-framework

Plan before a forecast storm

Question: A storm may isolate a community clinic that supports residents with chronic illness.
1. With authorized partners, identify who may lose access and which service dependencies are at risk.
2. Check the current local continuity, communication, referral, and emergency plans rather than inventing a new command structure.
3. Ask affected residents which accessible contact and support options are feasible, then record gaps for the responsible team.
Answer: Preparedness is advance risk and continuity planning with the health system and community.
Check: No medication dose, triage category, transport guarantee, or delegation authority is created.

Distinguish phases

Question: A learner says disaster nursing begins when an evacuation starts.
1. Identify the event’s potential health effects before impact.
2. Separate risk reduction and preparedness from response after an event begins.
3. Include recovery and restoration needs when planning with affected groups.
Answer: Disaster risk management spans before, during, and after emergencies.
Check: The framework does not dictate local procedures.

Common misconceptions

- Disaster management is not limited to emergency response after impact; preparation, readiness,
- and recovery are part of the health-risk framework.
- A framework does not supply local triage categories, evacuation authority, or incident-command
- assignments.
- Vulnerability is context-dependent; planning should include affected communities and avoid
- assuming that every person in a group has the same needs.
- Continuity planning does not authorize a nurse to promise transport, medication supply, or
- treatment outside current plans and role.

Practice patterns

- For a preparedness problem, identify the exposed people, service dependencies, communication
- gaps, and authorized local plan before selecting an action.
- For disaster phase questions, distinguish risk reduction/preparation from response and
- recovery.
- For community planning, include affected people and relevant authorized sectors while
- respecting privacy and local authority.

Official scope references

Official scope: Enhanced Tables of Specifications for the Subjects in the Nurses Licensure Examination — Professional Regulation Commission; Professional Regulatory Board of Nursing — https://www.prc.gov.ph/sites/default/files/2025-10%20%20published%20Enhanced%20TOS%20nuse.pdf
Official scope: Nursing Licensure Examination Program, August 2026 — Professional Regulation Commission; Professional Regulatory Board of Nursing — https://www.prc.gov.ph/sites/default/files/exam%20progam%20aug%202026%20nle%20(nursing)%20signed.pdf

Instructional references

Instructional reference: Health Emergency and Disaster Risk Management Framework — World Health Organization — https://www.who.int/publications/i/item/health-emergency-and-disaster-risk-management-framework

BoardPrep lesson material is original instruction. It is not an official examination document.
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